First News

15 April 2026 Wednesday

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

Wall Street rallied as renewed ceasefire hopes boosted risk sentiment. Dow up 0.66%, S&P 500 gaining 1.18%, Nasdaq 100 up 1.81%. Fear Index fell 7% WTI Crude & Brent Crude Oil declined. Safe-haven demand lifted Gold and Bitcoin, both posting solid gains.

Driven by optimism over mediation efforts in Pakistan for a second round of negotiations despite recent failures. WTI (Nymex): Front-month futures dropped 7.9% to settle at $91.28 a barrel. Brent (ICE Europe): Front-month futures fell 4.6% to settle at $94.79 a barrel.

Global oil demand expected to fall this year for the first time since 2020, as the Iran conflict drives prices higher and weakens consumption, says International Energy Agency

- Gulf producers could restore about half of halted output within 2 weeks once Hormuz transit resumes.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	4/14/2026	4/15/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	48,218	48,535	0.66%
S&P 500	6,886	6,967	1.18%
NASDAQ	23,183	23,639	1.97%
PCOMP	6,054	5,972	-1.35%
NKY	56,502	57,877	2.43%
SHCOMP	3988	4026	0.95%
HSI	25,660	25,872	0.83%
KOSPI	5808	5967	2.74%
SENSEX	76,847	76,847	0.00%
TWSE	35,457	36,296	2.37%
ASX200	8926	8970	0.49%
BURSAKLCI	1680	1688	0.48%
JCI	7500	7675	2.33%
STI	4984	5007	0.46%
SET	989	989	0.00%
VNINDEX	1758	1775	0.97%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	4/14/2026	4/15/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	96.85	91.46	-5.57%
Brent Crude	99.36	94.79	-4.60%
Gold (Comex)	4783	4864	1.69%
Silver (Comex)	76.04	79.56	4.63%
Copper (Comex)	606.25	614.4	1.34%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	92.5	92.5	0.00%
Coal	135.45	135.45	0.00%
Corn	451	452.5	0.33%
Wheat	591.25	601.25	1.69%
Cocoa	3365	3646	8.35%
Sugar	13.88	14.09	1.51%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

Philippine economic managers are opposing the suspension of excise taxes on diesel and gasoline because they believe it would not provide meaningful relief to consumers and would be largely offset by current market dynamics.

Tuesday 1/14/26
Net Foreign Selling
GTCAP FGEN DMC BPI BDO MBT URC CNPF JFC RFM AC ALI SM SMPH AEV WLCON TEL MYNLD SEVN PLUS

Tuesday 1/14/26
Net Foreign Buying
MWC ICT MER CREIT SHLPH MONDE RRHI ROCK SCC PX AT GLO CNVRG DITO MAC LTG PNB DDPR PGOLD SSI

Asian equities rose, led by artificial intelligence names, as sentiment improved amid signs the US and Iran may revive peace talks.

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

IMF Cuts Philippine GDP to 4.1%; Moody's Trims to 4.9%; Peso Recovers to ₱59 on Iran Deal Hopes

- **T**he macro downgrade barrage continued on Tuesday, with two more multilateral rating assessments reinforcing the severity of the Middle East-driven growth shock. The IMF slashed its 2026 Philippine GDP growth forecast to 4.1% from 5.6% in January — 1.5 percentage points below the government's 5–6% target and slower than 2025's post-pandemic low of 4.4%, citing the compound impact of the oil shock and the ongoing weakness from the flood control corruption scandal that stalled public investment. The IMF projects headline inflation at 4.3% this year, breaching its target, and flagged that the BSP should remain ready to tighten if inflation expectations de-anchor. Separately, Moody's Ratings cut its Philippine GDP growth forecast to 4.9% for 2026 from 5.5%, raised its inflation outlook to 3.7% from 3%, and warned that high pass-through from elevated oil prices is expected to erode real incomes and dampen consumption and industrial activity.
- Moody's noted that its baseline assumes a gradual recovery in public investment beginning only in the second half of 2026. On the FX front, the peso appreciated 26.5 centavos to close at ₱59.87 against the dollar on Tuesday, returning to the ₱59 level on improved risk sentiment tied to optimism that US-Iran negotiations could resume in Islamabad later this week.
- For Wednesday, traders see the peso ranging ₱59.50–₱60. The April 23 BSP policy meeting remains the next key domestic catalyst.
- **Market Implication:** The dual-downgrade from IMF and Moody's in a single session narrows the market's hope for a near-term policy pivot. The BSP is caught between supply-driven inflation and a softening growth trajectory. Equity markets should remain defensive. Rate-sensitive sectors — property, leveraged industrials — face headwinds; consumer staples and exporters with dollar revenues remain preferred.

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

6013 -40.95pts., 0.68%

Range 6,013.10-6,065.62

Breadth 110 (+) 93 (-) 61 (unch)

Block Php269mn **Volume** 1.48bn **Value** Php5.91bn

Share buyback MEG OPM AGI

52wk H: bncom crec dhi mwc sgp
52wk L: allhc chp ferro idc jfc mm pbb sun tech ubp

Overbought – rrhi crec dhi spnec
Oversold – abs jfc urc tfhi

Active	Value
ICT	1,050
BDO	481
JFC	457
BPI	325
PGOLD	289
ALI	274
MWC	251
URC	212
PLUS	140

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$7.473mn
Total Month FB/(FS)	-$107.186mn
YTD NFB	$73.239mn
FB	2,730,295,332.03
FS	3,177,069,799.96
NFB(S)	-446,774,467.93
TOTAL	5,907,365,131.99

Foreign Funds Bought
pnb mer mwc scc shlph spc top axlm monde agi ltg creit rock dito glo cnvrg ict mac ceu pgold rrhi at px

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi cbc mbt secb dhi acen alter ap bsc fgen mynld pcor spnec cnpf dnl emi jfc keepr rfm urc mwide imi ac aev dmc gtcap jgs sm smc ali areit filrt meg mreit rcr smph tel sti bloom plus web sevn wlcon apx fni marc nikl ogp

Global Funds Net Buyers
Wednesday 4/8/26: ICT GLO SGP CREIT BDO MBT PNB APX PX SCC PLUS IMI AEV JGS DMC LTG AP PGOLD MONDE MAC

	4/14/...	4/15...	%Chg
10yr Bond			
PHL	6.602	6.605	0.05%
US	4.285	4.243	-0.98%
Currency Pair			
USD-JPY	159.62	158.64	-0.61%
USD-PHP	60.16	59.878	-0.47%
USD-CNY	6.8308	6.816	-0.22%
EUR-USD	1.1705	1.1804	0.85%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MBT 67.40

- **Metrobank lists PHP35 billion ASEAN Sustainability Bonds on PDEx**

GLO 1635.0

- **Globe Telecom recently executed a plan to refinance its $600 million senior perpetual capital securities (issued in 2021) using proceeds from a massive ₱25 billion preferred shares offer completed in March 2026**

CLI 2.54

- **CLI posts record P24.6B residential reservation sales, up 45%; closes 2025 with steady earnings and strong demand momentum**

CPG ₱0.67

- **Phirst Park absorption into listed parent is positive governance signal. Watch ASM shareholder vote.**

SMC ₱69.20 ₱7.78B

- **Boracay bridge awarded (uncontested). Peso-denominated toll concessions hedge macro volatility. Watch SLEX TR4 partial opening.**

SCC ₱29.95

- **10.8% yield, P/E 9.8x, ₱35 target — compelling fundamentals. But soft price momentum; preferred entry ₱27–29 for better margin of safety.**

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

LTG 15.06

- **Eton CX overhaul reduces delivery risk. PNB +4.38% on April 14 is a positive group signal.**

- **Tanduay Eyes Wider Global Reach with Central/Eastern Europe Expansion and Product Innovation**
- Tanduay Distillers, an LT Group subsidiary, is pushing deeper into global markets through new European distribution partnerships and a premium product innovation strategy anchored by its Reserve Rum 10 Years and Especia Spiced Rum lines. The company is in active talks with potential distribution partners across Slovenia, Slovakia, Hungary, and broader Central and Eastern Europe, adding to existing footholds in the US, Belgium, Ukraine, and the UAE. Its "Rum from the Islas" campaign positions the brand for premium spirits shelf space, with recent international wins including Double Gold at the Asia Spirits Ratings. As the world's No. 1 rum by volume (per Drinks International, holding the title since 2017), Tanduay's shift toward premium-led international growth could improve margin mix and reduce dependence on high-volume, low-margin domestic sales. Tanduay is a significant LTG segment contributor alongside its banking (PNB) and tobacco (Fortune Tobacco) businesses.
- **Stance on LTG: MONITOR** — Tanduay's international diversification is a long-term positive, but near-term LTG performance is more directly driven by PNB's credit quality and Fortune Tobacco's margin dynamics. Watch for Tanduay revenue contribution growth in forthcoming LTG results.

PAL 3.35
MAC 4.45

- **Pacific expansion positive; Middle East suspension + fuel costs cap upside. Ceasefire-outcome dependent.**

VMC 1.94

- **50,000L/day bioethanol capacity upgrade; energy security play. Watch DOE biofuel mandate catalyst.**

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

GLO 1,633.00

- **Globe Launches Tender Offer for $600M in Perpetual Securities**
- Globe Telecom launched a tender offer to buy back its full $600 million in 4.2% senior perpetual capital securities originally issued in October 2021, offering holders $1,000 per $1,000 principal plus accrued distributions; the tender opened April 14 and expires April 22, with settlement on April 24.
- The buyback is part of Globe's active liability management program aimed at retiring perpetual debt that carries ongoing distribution obligations, with the securities featuring a step-up cost structure that makes them progressively more expensive if not redeemed. Globe had earlier raised ₱25 billion through a preferred share offering in February 2026 specifically to fund this redemption ahead of the August 2, 2026 first call date. Retiring the perpetuals eliminates a significant recurring distribution burden and simplifies the balance sheet, with positive implications for Globe's long-term cost of capital. Combined with the Candle Cable System infrastructure announcement, this week's events reflect a Globe management team actively optimizing both operations and the liability stack.
- **Stance on GLO: ACCUMULATE** — Debt retirement removes a costly liability overhang; balance sheet simplification is a positive re-rating catalyst alongside the infrastructure submarine cable story.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MER 617.00

- **Regulated pass-through insulates margins. May billing carries real oil shock. Accumulate near ₱590–600.**

- **MPower Wins 60-Store Starbucks Supply Contract Under Retail Aggregation Program**
- MPower, Meralco's retail electricity supply unit, will provide electricity to 60 Starbucks stores in Metro Manila operated by Rustan Coffee Corp., consolidating a combined load of over 3 megawatts under the Retail Aggregation Program to enable cost efficiencies and support sustainability goals.
- The RAP allows smaller energy consumers to pool demand and access competitive market rates directly from retail electricity suppliers — historically available only to large industrial users. This deal marks a significant expansion of RAP into the food and beverage retail sector, with Starbucks as a flagship showcase. For Meralco and MPower, it signals a growing B2B revenue stream in retail electricity supply that is incremental to its traditional distribution business. The enrollment began in November 2025, demonstrating the contractual durability of the relationship.
- **Stance on MER: MONITOR** — MPower's RAP growth is a positive margin diversifier, but MER's near-term earnings remain under pressure from the May generation charge passthrough and peso-denominated cost escalation. The stock's defensive characteristics and regulated return model offer support.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

CLI 2.50

- **Sets ₱12–14B 2026 Capex; Acquires 70-Hectare Cavite Property for Luzon Debut**
- Cebu Landmasters set a ₱12–14 billion capital expenditure budget for 2026, down from ₱16 billion in 2025, with 60–70% allocated to project development; the company reported 2025 full-year net income of ₱4.03 billion on consolidated revenues of ₱18.5 billion — revenues declined 7.4% on project timing factors, but core real estate sales excluding lot sales rose 10% to ₱17.3 billion.
- The company also separately disclosed the acquisition of a 70-hectare property in Dasmariñas, Cavite — its flagship Luzon township entry — with initial project phases targeted for launch between 2027 and 2028. CLI remains the dominant developer in the Visayas-Mindanao market and is now executing a long-anticipated Luzon expansion backed by NTT UD Asia's 40% stake in its Luzon-focused subsidiary. The lower 2026 capex reflects a deliberate moderation after the large 2025 spending cycle, maintaining financial discipline. CLI's zero-bank-debt record and strong VisMin reservation sales (described as record-high in 2025) provide a solid funding foundation.
- **Stance on CLI: ACCUMULATE** — Luzon expansion thesis is de-risking with land acquisition and JV partnership in place; core VisMin earnings are stable; disciplined capex is positive for balance sheet. Macro risks to buyer sentiment from high inflation are a near-term watch.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

JFC 159.50

- **Smashburger is surging! Following the "Summer of Smash" campaign, company-owned SSS improved from negative mid-teens to positive double-digit growth by March 2026. Higher traffic is driving this major comeback.**
- Smashburger Targets 10–12 New US Store Openings; SSS Swings to Positive Double-Digit Growth
- Jollibee Foods Corp. disclosed that Smashburger plans to open 10 to 12 new stores in 2026 across traditional and non-traditional formats — including five airport locations and one university — following a sharp same-store sales turnaround from negative mid-teen declines in Q3 2025 to positive double-digit growth by March 2026, driven by higher transaction volumes and the "Summer of Smash" brand campaign.
- JFC CFO Richard Shin highlighted the brand's strengthening role as a scalable, asset-light growth platform within the international portfolio. Smashburger's turnaround is meaningful for JFC's overall brand portfolio narrative, as the US burger market has been one of the more challenging segments to fix. With JFC targeting 8–12% systemwide sales growth for 2026 and spending ₱13–16 billion in capex, the Smashburger momentum is a constructive addition. JFC shares closed at ₱159.50, down 1.48% on Tuesday.
- **Stance on JFC: ACCUMULATE** — Smashburger recovery validates the international portfolio strategy and supports earnings momentum. Macro headwinds from higher input costs and peso weakness are risks, but JFC's diversified multi-brand, multi-market model provides resilience.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

EMI 15.40

- S**ecures €300M Sustainability-Linked Loan — First for a Philippine F&B Company**
- Emperador secured a €300-million sustainability-linked loan (approximately ₱21 billion) through a banking syndicate led by BBVA, Bank of China (Hong Kong), and DBS Bank to refinance existing debt of its wholly owned subsidiary Emperador International Ltd., with the loan tied to two KPIs: reduction of Scope 1 and 2 greenhouse gas emission intensity and increased use of renewable electricity.
- This marks the first sustainability-linked loan for the Emperador group and the first for any Philippine food and beverage company. The SLL structure incentivizes Emperador to hit its green targets by linking interest costs to ESG performance — meeting targets triggers better pricing, while missing them raises the cost. Emperador already operates bioenergy, biomass, and solar assets across its Philippines, Scotland, Spain, and Mexico facilities. The transaction is fundamentally a refinancing, but the ESG linkage expands Emperador's access to a broader pool of ESG-mandate capital globally and improves its profile with international institutional investors.
- **Stance on EMI: ACCUMULATE** — ESG-linked refinancing at favorable terms reduces cost of capital and opens new investor channels. Emperador's global distribution across 100 countries and its dominant brandy position provide earnings resilience against local macro headwinds.

VMC 1.94

- **Q2 FY2026 Net Income Up 2.3% on Lower Costs Despite Revenue Decline**
- Victorias Milling reported a 2.33% increase in quarterly attributable net income to ₱511.46 million for the three months ended February 2026, as a 25.4% decline in cost of sales and services more than offset a 20.1% drop in total revenues to ₱3.38 billion; operating expenses also fell 8.28%.
- However, for the six-month period ended February, attributable net income fell 22.6% to ₱673.75 million from ₱870.57 million, reflecting what the company called "continuing industry challenges and evolving market conditions." The quarter's earnings quality rests primarily on cost reduction rather than topline strength — a pattern that warrants monitoring as the milling season progresses into higher-revenue months. VMC remains debt-free with a diversified revenue mix including sugar milling, distillery/ethanol, and biomass power generation. VMC shares last traded at ₱1.94.
- **Stance on VMC: MONITOR** — Cost management is keeping earnings afloat against a soft revenue backdrop; six-month earnings are still materially down year-on-year. Sugar price dynamics and ethanol revenue trends are the key swing factors for the second half of the crop year.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/13/2026	4/14/2026	%Chg
AC	544	529.5	-2.67%
ACEN	3.03	3.02	-0.33%
AEV	31	31	0.00%
ALI	18.06	17.4	-3.65%
AREIT	39.5	39.9	1.01%
BDO	117	116	-0.85%
BPI	99	99.2	0.20%
CBC	62	62.7	1.13%
CNPF	32	32	0.00%
CNVRG	12.38	12.5	0.97%
DMC	10	10.02	0.20%
EMI	15.38	15.4	0.13%
GLO	1,630.00	1,633.00	0.18%
GTCAP	510	503	-1.37%
ICT	734	720	-1.91%
JFC	161.9	159.5	-1.48%
JGS	27.2	26.85	-1.29%

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/13/2026	4/14/2026	%Chg
LTG	14.74	15.06	2.17%
MBT	67.3	67.5	0.30%
MER	608	617	1.48%
MONDE	6.54	6.98	6.73%
PGOLD	41.5	42.35	2.05%
PLUS	16.7	15.8	-5.39%
RCR	6.9	6.92	0.29%
SCC	29.95	30	0.17%
SM	621	610	-1.77%
SMC	69.2	68.9	-0.43%
SMPH	19.8	20	1.01%
TEL	1,284.00	1,283.00	-0.08%
URC	60	59.9	-0.17%

TRENDING STOCKS

DIVIDEND YIELD INDEX (PSE DivY)

	4/13/2026	4/14/2026	%Chg
AREIT	39.5	39.9	1.01%
CBC	62	62.7	1.13%
CREIT	3.55	3.55	0.00%
DMC	10	10.02	0.20%
DNL	3.7	3.7	0.00%
GLO	1,630.00	1,633.00	0.18%
LTG	14.74	15.06	2.17%
MBT	67.3	67.5	0.30%
MER	608	617	1.48%
MREIT	13.78	13.7	-0.58%
NIKL	4.8	4.95	3.13%
OGP	34	34.95	2.79%
PGOLD	41.5	42.35	2.05%
RCR	6.9	6.92	0.29%
RLC	17.2	17.6	2.33%
RRHI	46.4	46.3	-0.22%
SCC	29.95	30	0.17%
SGP	23.05	23	-0.22%
TEL	1,284.00	1,283.00	-0.08%
URC	60	59.9	-0.17%

TRENDING STOCKS

PSE MidCap

	4/13/2026	4/14/2026	%Chg
AGI	9.85	9.74	-1.12%
APX	18.3	17.8	-2.73%
AUB	42	42.1	0.24%
BLOOM	2.05	2.02	-1.46%
COSCO	7.1	7.15	0.70%
DNL	3.7	3.7	0.00%
GSMI	267.2	269.2	0.75%
KEEPR	2.2	2.23	1.36%
MEG	2.04	2.05	0.49%
MREIT	13.78	13.7	-0.58%
MWC	43.3	43.5	0.46%
NIKL	4.8	4.95	3.13%
OGP	34	34.95	2.79%
PNB	60.8	60.15	-1.07%
RLC	17.2	17.6	2.33%
RRHI	46.4	46.3	-0.22%
SECB	68	68	0.00%
SEVN	34	33	-2.94%
SGP	23.05	23	-0.22%
WLCON	6.4	6.39	-0.16%